

An *integer*, or *int*, is a number that doesn't have a decimal point. A *float* is a number that does.

The `type()` function identifies the data type of its argument.

```
>>> type(3)
<class 'int'>
>>> type(3.5)
<class 'float'>
```

The `float()` function converts an integer to a float:

```
>>> float(3)
3.0
```

Sometimes numerical information starts as a string. The `float()` function converts properly formatted strings to floats:

```
>>> float('3.5')
3.5
```

The `int()` function converts floats to integers by dropping the number's decimal portion, not by rounding:

```
>>> int(3.0)
3
>>> int(3.9)
3
```

The `int()` function also converts strings to integers:

```
>>> int('3')
3
```